

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a 3/4 time signature. The melody is accompanied by guitar chords and fingerings. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, each with three lines of text. The chords are indicated by letters (E, F#m, B, A, Bsus, G#) and guitar-specific symbols (x, o, x, o, x). Fingerings are indicated by numbers 1-4 and letters o, x.

System 1:

Chords: E (1 4 2), F#m (2 1 3), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2)

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

System 2:

Chords: E (1 4 2), A (2 1), Bsus (2 3 1 1), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2)

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

System 3:

Chords: A (2 1), F#m (2 1 3), G# (4 1 3 2)

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

System 4:

Chords: E/G# (x x o x), G#m (1 3 4 2), F#m (2 1 3), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2)

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.